The next day, Anirudhya visited *The Hindu* office and looked for Prakash Swamy, who had got the controversial photograph from the forensics giant Chandrasekharan. He wasn't expecting a guest. However, a courteous man, Swamy invited Anirudhya to the canteen for coffee. The latter inquired about the photographs from Haribabu's camera. The senior reporter was all smiles but wouldn't open his mouth to someone he was seeing for the first time—who was also a competitor. However, he did drop one hint for the reporter who had come all the way from Delhi. He said the photo had been edited. There was a white-kurta-pyjama-clad man in it too, who was cropped out of the image on the advice of the forensics boss Chandrasekharan.

About Chandrasekharan 'leaking the photo' to his paper, Swamy told Anirudhya that it was probably that the forensic lab wanted to prove what it was capable of—and, of course, it wanted to help the investigation too. Nobody among the locals was too happy about the way New Delhi had been imposing the SIT on Tamil Nadu officers and stealing all the credit. Chandrasekharan's leaking the photo to the press had been criticized, but it had also helped the SIT get a 'start' on the case. Nobody knew at that point that these photos would prove to be the biggest clue in times to come.

At South Block, New Delhi, two crucial meetings took place back to back. In the first, Prime Minister Chandra Shekhar spoke to the chief of R&AW G.S. Bajpai and asked him what the R&AW was doing when speculations about the LTTE's involvement were rife across the media. People would see it as a failure in assessing the threat perceptibility on the former PM's life by a premier intelligence agency such as R&AW. But Bajpai was unwilling to see reason in the speculations. He reportedly told the Prime Minister that a day after the assassination, the chief of the LTTE's International Secretariat in London, Sathasivam Krishnakumar, alias Kittu, had denied the group's involvement in the assassination. The head of R&AW's